

MINI ASSESSMENT

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DEPT	CSE(DS)
Date	11-09-2026

Q1. If an API returns 429, what should your program do?

Answer: A 429 status code means that the program has sent more requests to the API than allowed within a specific time period.

- The program should not continuously send requests because this can make the problem worse.
- It should wait for some time before trying again, preferably following the “Retry-After” value provided by the server.
- If that value is not available, the program can use an increasing delay between retries.
- The program should also set a maximum number of retry attempts and handle the failure gracefully if the API still does not respond successfully.

Q2. If response.json() fails, what should your program do?

Answer: If response.json() fails, the response received from the server may not contain valid JSON data.

- This can happen when the server returns an empty response, plain text, or an HTML error page instead of JSON.
- The program should use try-except to catch the error and prevent the application from crashing.
- It should also check the HTTP status code and response content to identify what went wrong.
- After handling the error, the program can display a meaningful message or use a suitable fallback value.

Q3. If a JSON key is missing, why might .get() be safer than []?

Answer: Using .get() is safer when we are not certain that a particular key exists in the JSON data.

- With data['key'], Python raises a KeyError if the key is missing, which can interrupt the program.
- However, data.get('key') returns None when the key is unavailable, allowing the program to continue normally.
- We can also provide a default value, such as data.get('key', 'Not Available').
- Therefore, .get() is useful for handling incomplete or unexpected API responses and makes the code more reliable.